

FORM TP 2012009



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JANUARY 2012

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1 hour 45 minutes

11 JANUARY 2012 (p.m.)

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This paper consists of THREE questions.
2. Answer ALL questions.
3. Begin EACH question on a new page.
4. Each question is worth 15 marks.
5. You should use 15 minutes of the time allowed to read through the entire paper.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN THIS PAPER.

SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the extract below carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

(Enter MR JACK.)

CELSUS: Eh-eh, look de pall-bearer¹, oui.

HELEN: De what?

CELSUS: De pall-bearer. Mr Jack.

- 5 HELEN: Oh, you mean de best man.

CELSUS: Is a pall-bearer he is, oui, because right now I feel is me funeral I going to an' is bury dey going an' bury me.

MR JACK: Well, Aleck boy, you ready to go to church?

CELSUS: I not ready to go nowhere. An' stop calling me Aleck, my name is Celsus.

- 10 HELEN: You'll take a drink, Mr Jack?

MR JACK: Yes thanks, Helen.

HELEN: I'll get it for you. *(Exit.)*

MR JACK: Well, dis is an important day for you, boy. You not feeling nervous?

CELSUS: Nervous for what? People does feel nervous when dey tie up, nuh?

- 15 MR JACK: I can remember my wedding day as if it was yesterday. I was a young man of twenty.

CELSUS: Wait, you mean dey ca-coa² you too?

MR JACK: What?

CELSUS: You mean dey ca-coa you too?

- 20 MR JACK: What you mean by dat?

CELSUS: Well, if you married when you was only twenty years your wife must have ca-coa you, because no man in Dominica does married at dat age of his own free will.

MR JACK: Look, pal, I doh come here for you to insult me like dat, eh.

- CELSUS: But your wife is a old soucouyant³ for her to ca-coa you like dat, man.
- 25 MR JACK: What! How you can call my wife a soucouyant, nuh. (*MR JACK pushes CELSUS.*)
- CELSUS: But dat's what she is, man. Everybody know dat. An' doh push me, man.
- MR JACK: But you damn rude, man. (*He pushes CELSUS again.*)
- CELSUS: An' you damn stupid. Doh push me, man. (*CELSUS pushes MR JACK.*)
- MR JACK: Oh, is fight you want?
- 30 CELSUS: Is dat, so come.

(*They fight. Enter HELEN with drink.*)

¹ pall-bearer – a person helping to carry or officially escorting a coffin at a funeral

² ca-coa – bewitch/cast a spell on

³ soucouyant – she-devil

*Adapted from Alwin Bully,
"Good Morning, Miss Millie".
In Champions of the Gayelle, Macmillan, 2002, pp. 18–20.*

- (a) To what does "an important day" (line 13) refer? (1 mark)
- (b) (i) Celsus sees himself as being "ca-coa". Identify TWO other images that capture how he sees his condition. (2 marks)
- (ii) Explain what the images identified in (b) (i) above suggest about Celsus' feeling about his condition. (2 marks)
- (c) What TWO differences in attitudes to marriage are presented in this scene? Support your answer. (4 marks)
- (d) (i) Identify ONE comic incident in this scene. (1 mark)
- (ii) What dramatic functions does Helen's exit (line 12) and entrance (line 31) serve? (2 marks)
- (e) Suggest a title for this scene. Justify your answer. (3 marks)

Total 15 marks

SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the poem below carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Catching Crabs

Ruby and me stalking savannah
Crab season with cutlass and sack like big folk.
Hiding behind stones or clumps of bush
Crabs locked knee-deep in mud mating
5 And Ruby, seven years old feeling strange at the sex
And me horrified to pick them up
Plunge them into the darkness of bag.
So all day we scout to catch the lonesome ones
Who don't mind cooking because they got no prospect
10 Of family, and squelching through the mud,
Cutlass clearing bush at our feet,
We come home tired slow, weighed down with plenty
Which Ma throw live into boiling pot piece-piece.
Tonight we'll have one big happy curry feed,
15 We'll test out who teeth and jaw strongest
Who will grow up to be the biggest
Or who will make most terrible cannibal.

We leave behind a mess of bones and shell.
And come to England and America
20 Where Ruby hustles in a New York tenement
And me writing poetry at Cambridge,
Death long catch Ma, the house boarded up
Breeding wasps, woodlice in its dark-sack belly;
I am afraid to walk through weed yard,
25 Reach the door, prise open, look,
In case the pot still bubbles magical
On the fireside, and I see Ma.

*David Dabydeen, "Catching Crabs".
In The Heinemann Book of Caribbean Verse,
Heinemann, 1992, p. 61.*

- (a) State TWO activities which occur in stanza 1 of the poem. **(2 marks)**
- (b) State ONE difference between stanzas 1 and 2. Support your answer with evidence from the poem. **(2 marks)**
- (c) Identify the literary device used in ONE of the following phrases and comment on its effectiveness.
- “squelching through the mud” (line 10)
 - “Death long catch Ma” (line 22)
 - “the house boarded up/breeding wasps” (lines 22–23) **(3 marks)**
- (d) Suggest TWO feelings which the speaker in the poem experiences. **(2 marks)**
- (e) (i) Comment on the poet’s use of the crab image in this poem. **(3 marks)**
- (ii) Suggest another title for this poem. Justify your choice. **(3 marks)**

Total 15 marks

SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the extract below carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Damballah¹ was the word. Said it to Aunty Lissy and she went upside his head, harder than she had ever slapped him. Felt like crumpling right there in the dust of the yard it hurt so bad but he bit his lip and didn't cry out, held his ground and said the word again and again silently to himself, pretending nothing but a bug on his burning cheek and twitched and sent it flying. Damballah.

5 Be strong as he needed to be. Nothing touch him if he don't want. Before long they'd cut him from the herd of pickaninnies². No more chasing flies from the table, no more silver spoons to get shiny, no fat, old woman telling him what to do. He'd go to the fields each morning with the men. Holler like they did before the sun rose to burn off the mist. Work like they did from can to caint. From first crack of light to dusk when the puddles of shadow deepened and spread so you

10 couldn't see your hands or your feet or the sharp tools hacking at the cane.

He was already taller than the others, a stork³ among the chicks scurrying behind Aunt Lissy. Soon he'd rise with the conch horn and do a man's share so he had let the fire rage on half his face and thought of the nothing always there to think of. In the spoon, his face long and thin as a finger. He looked for the print of Lissy's black hand on his cheek, but the image would not

15 stay still. Dancing like his face reflected in the river. Damballah. "Don't you ever, you hear me, ever let me hear that heathen talk no more. You hear me, boy? You talk Merican⁴, boy." Lissy's voice like chicken cackle. And his head a barn packed with animal noise and animal smell. His own head but he had to sneak round in it. Too many others crowded in there with him. His head so crowded and noisy lots of time don't hear his own voice with all them braying and cackling.

¹ Damballah – one of the most important Gods in voodoo religion

² pickaninnies – black children

³ stork – large, long-legged bird with a long neck and bill

⁴ Merican – American

*John Edgar Whiteman, "Damballah".
In Children of the Night, Little Brown and
Company Ltd., 1995, pp. 103–104.*

- (a) (i) Why did Aunt Lissy slap the boy? (1 mark)
- (ii) Identify ONE expression from the extract which shows the intensity of the slap. (1 mark)
- (b) Select ONE image used to present the relationship between Aunt Lissy and the pickaninnies and comment on its effectiveness. (3 marks)
- (c) What TWO impressions of the boy are created? Support your answer with evidence from the passage. (4 marks)

- (d) (i) What does Aunt Lissy refer to as “heathen talk” (line 16)? (1 mark)
- (ii) What do the words spoken by Aunt Lissy “Don’t you ever ... Merican, boy” (lines 15–16) suggest about her values? (2 marks)
- (e) Identify the literary device in the sentence “And his head a barn packed with animal noise and animal smell.” (line 17) and comment on its effectiveness. (3 marks)

Total 15 marks

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.

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